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Professor Roman Słowiński
Co-ordinating Editor-in-Chief
European Journal of Operational Research
Institute of Computing Science, Poznań University of Technology
60-965 Poznań, Poland

Dear Professor Słowiński,

Please find enclosed our manuscript, **"Pairwise Judging versus Voting for Language Model Answer Selection: Finite-Pool Theory and an Empirical Audit,"** for consideration as a Theory and Methodology paper in the *European Journal of Operational Research*.

The paper derives an exact accuracy comparison between binary Copeland selection and plurality voting for three independently generated candidates, with finite-pool extensions. It combines this result with a composite answer selector, an exact integerized Kemeny–Young reference and a stored-output ground-truth audit. The theoretical contribution quantifies the comparison reliability needed to improve answer correctness; the ranking reference evaluates agreement with the judge's preferences.

On six benchmarks (532 distinct problems), the tested free-tier judge configuration has no statistically detected homogeneous-pool advantage over voting and lower pooled heterogeneous-pool accuracy. Offline ablations identify an objective-scale mismatch and compare alternative selectors on the same saved comparisons. The Theory and Methodology contribution is the finite-pool analysis together with a decision-analytic audit separating ranking fit, objective design and correctness. Code, public stored runs and tables are archived on Zenodo (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.24112045), with data-access conditions described in the manuscript.

Sincerely,

Aris Dressino